

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Bladder Stimulators (Pacemakers)

230.16

Links in PDF documents are not guaranteed to work. To follow a web link, please use the MCD Website.

Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

230.16

Manual Section Title

Bladder Stimulators (Pacemakers)

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

10/07/1996

Description Information

Benefit Category

Prosthetic Devices

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

There are a number of devices available to induce emptying of the urinary bladder by using electrical current which forces the muscles of the bladder to contract. These devices (commonly known as bladder stimulators or pacemakers) are characterized by the implantation of electrodes in the wall of the bladder, the rectal cones, or the spinal cord. While these treatments may effectively empty the bladder, the issue of safety involving the initiation of infection, erosion, placement, and material selection has not been resolved.

Further, some facilities previously using electronic emptying have stopped using this method due to the pain experienced by the patient.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

The use of spinal cord electrical stimulators, rectal electrical stimulators, and bladder wall stimulators is not considered reasonable and necessary. Therefore, no program payment may be made for these devices or for their implant.

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

89

Revision History

09/1996 - Eliminated use of name brand products. Effective date 10/07/1996. (TN 89)

02/1995 - Reflected that pelvic floor stimulators used as a treatment for urinary incontinence are not covered. Effective date 03/01/1995. (TN 74)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Bladder Stimulators (Pacemakers)	1	10/07/1996 - N/A	You are here